

Operating Procedures and Standards

Airfield Entry



Before driving on the airfield, you must have:

- Authorization to enter the Controlled Area
- A license or certification to operate a vehicle
- Completed the base's Airfield Driver Training Course
- Completed an initial airfield driver's check ride

Once these requirements have been met, you will receive your AF Form 483, Certificate of Competency, endorsed for the airfield driving at your base.

FOD 1

Vehicle operation "on the airfield is a major source of foreign objects that damage aircraft tires and are ingested into jet engines with disastrous results".

Whenever you enter the airfield or have driven on an unpaved area of the airfield, you will be required to perform a FOD check prior to driving on any surfaced area of the airfield that aircraft use with engines running.

"When motor vehicles are operated on unpaved surfaces, rocks may become lodged between dual wheels and gravel may stick in the tire treads. When entering the ramp area or Airfield, operators will perform FOD checks IAW DAFI 13-213, Paragraph 4.13."

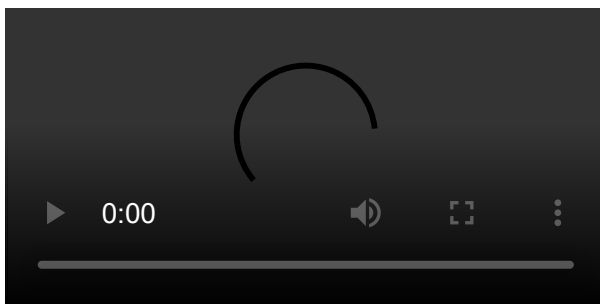


FOD 2

Comply with local Airfield Driving Instructions and FOD Prevention Program precautions.

- Check tires and remove objects lodged in the tread and/or between dual tires.
- Ensure that any loose objects on/in the vehicle are secured/stowed.
- Perform a FOD Check anytime you enter the airfield or return to a paved area of the airfield after driving off the pavement.

FOD prevention is your responsibility.



Driving Near Aircraft 1

On the airfield we have speed limits that will never be exceeded, except by emergency response vehicles responding to an actual emergency. A "Red Ball" is not an emergency.

There are maximum limits of 5 MPH, 10 MPH and 15 MPH, on the apron and vary by proximity to aircraft and vehicle type.

Maximum speed limits may be amended to lower limits if local conditions require.

The speed limits on the taxiway or inactive runways will be determined by the installation commander.

Ask your Airfield Driving Program Manager about specific speed limits for your airfield ramp(s), taxiways and inactive runway(s).

5MPH: Any vehicle operating within 50 feet of an aircraft.



10MPH: Special Purpose Vehicles



15MPH: General Purpose Vehicles

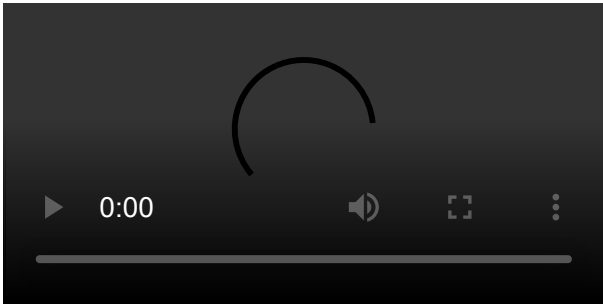


Driving Near Aircraft 2

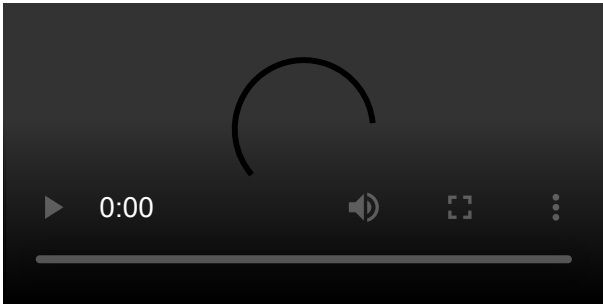
It is essential that you rigidly adhere to traffic flow and driving near aircraft rules. Violating these rules will eventually result in an aircraft incident.

Traffic Flow Rules:

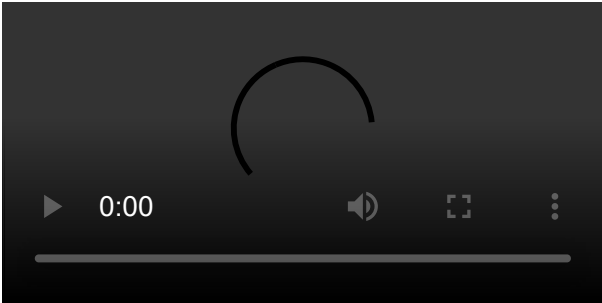
- Always drive and park with the driver's side of the vehicle towards aircraft.
- Drive parallel to aircraft taxiways where marked.
- Cross aprons perpendicular to taxi lanes and aircraft parking spot rows.



Parking:



Drive Parallel:

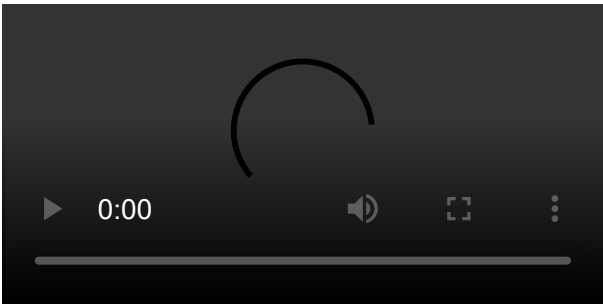


Cross Perpendicular:

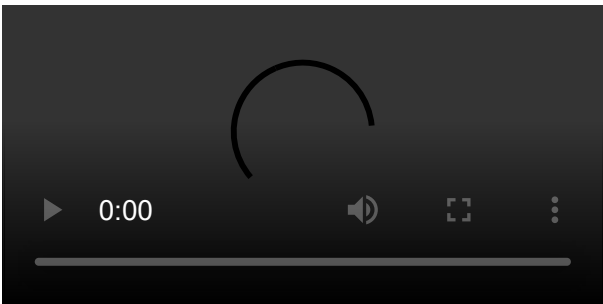
Driving Near Aircraft 3

Traffic Flow Rules (continued):

- YIELD right-of-way to taxiing aircraft, including helicopters in "hover taxi".
- Never drive in front of moving aircraft or between a "Follow Me" vehicle and taxiing aircraft!



Helo Taxi:



Follow Me:

Driving Near Aircraft 4

We drive on the airfield to support aircraft operations and often have to park, chock, and backup our vehicle in the performance of our jobs.

Rules for Parking, Chocking, and Backing up:

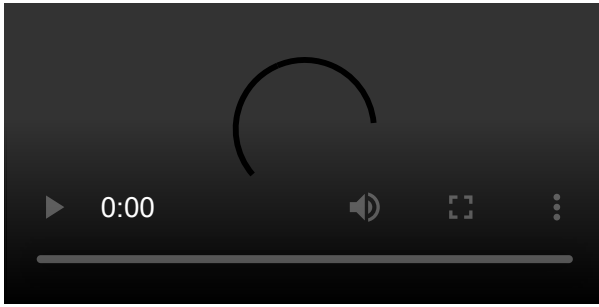
- Within 25 ft of an aircraft you will not back up toward the aircraft without a "spotter" to guide you and a pre-positioned chock to prevent you from backing into the aircraft.
- When remaining in the vehicle, set the parking brake. Place automatic transmissions to PARK or place manual transmissions to reverse.



Driving Near Aircraft 5

Rules for parking, chocking, and backing up near aircraft with engines running are as follows:

- When the engines are running or are about to be started, do not park within 25 ft in front of, within 200 ft to the rear of, or within Danger Areas specified for the aircraft.
- When the engines are running or are about to be started, do not park to the side of an aircraft where the personnel in the cockpit cannot see you. Establish eye contact, if possible.



Driving Near Aircraft 6

Jet Blast Hazard:

- Be aware of engine run parking spots on your airfield.
- Minimum standards are 25 feet in front and 200 feet to the rear of an aircraft. This is applicable when engines are idle or in a slow taxi speed. Larger aircraft taxiing or during idle engine runs require greater distances, up to 600 feet.
- Maintain situational awareness and avoid driving behind aircraft when maintenance personnel are in front of an aircraft while position lights are on and engines are running.
- Never drive behind an aircraft while the engines are being run above idle during an engine maintenance run.



Driving Near Aircraft 7

At some point you will need to leave your vehicle.

Unattended Vehicle Parking Rules:

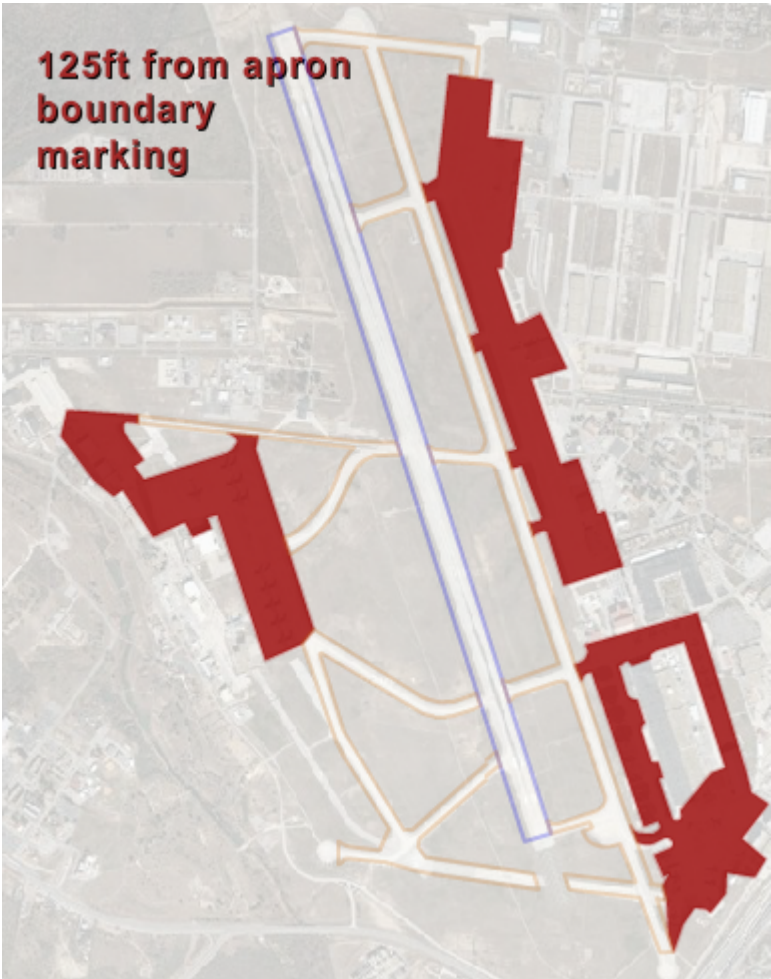
- When required to temporarily leave the vehicle, park so that your vehicle does not interfere with aircraft being taxied or towed.
- Turn the ignition switch off and leave the keys in the switch.
- Set the parking brake and place the transmission in PARK with an automatic transmission, or REVERSE with a manual transmission. Local Operating Instructions may require you to "chock" the vehicle.
- **Emergency and Alert Vehicles responding to an emergency or alert are exempt from these requirements.**

**Mobile Obstacles**

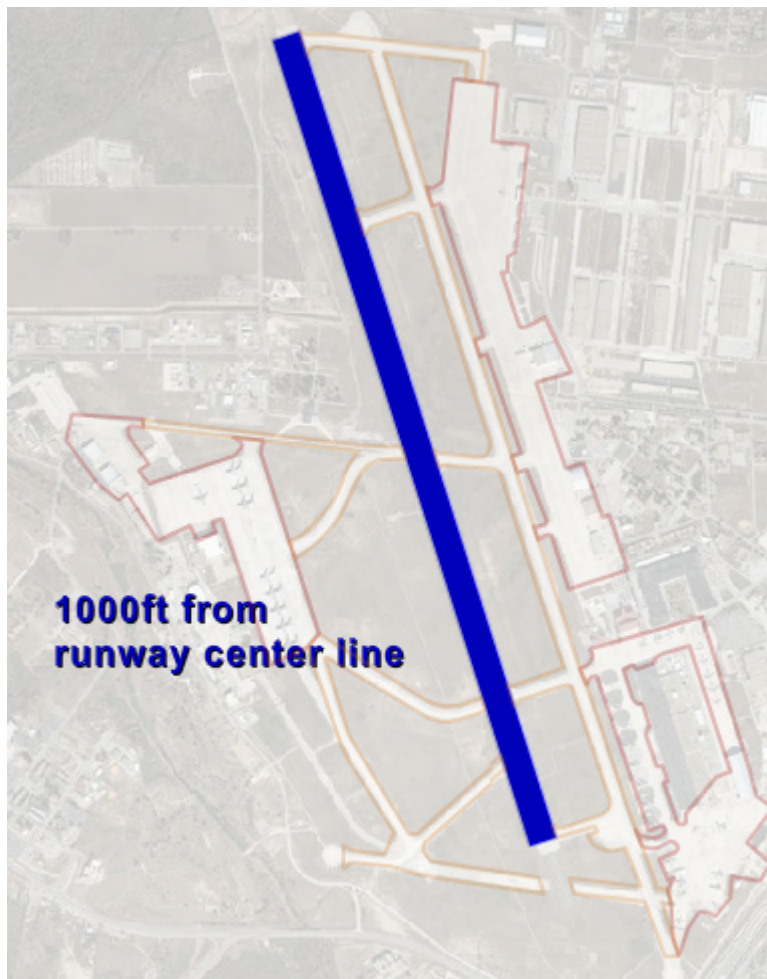
You have learned that being aware of the position of your vehicle with relation to aircraft is essential to safe airfield operations. Additionally, you are responsible for ensuring that your work remains free of mobile obstacles.

Ensure that you are aware of stricter local obstacle clearance procedures.

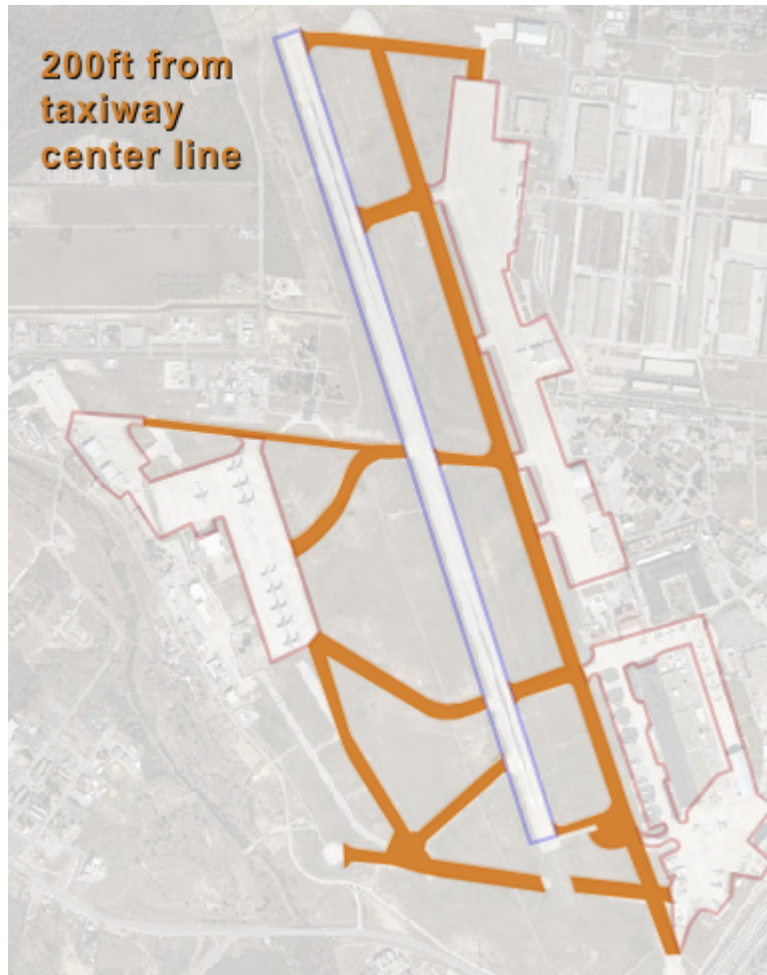
Obstacles:



Apron:



Runway:



Taxiways:

Summary

In this module you were introduced to Airfield entry requirements, Foreign Object Damage (FOD) prevention, precautions for driving near aircraft, and rules on mobile obstacles.

You are now able to identify who authorizes controlled entry, and licensing/training/check ride requirements. You can state general procedures for a FOD tire check, and driving off of pavement.

Additionally, you are able to identify airfield speed limits, traffic flow/parking rules, and clearance distances for mobile obstacles.